

Emilio Aguinaldo's Proclamation of Surrender to the United States, April 19, 1901 ²³

With the arrival of American reinforcements in March 1899, the United States' campaign against the Filipinos quickly gained momentum in many parts of the Philippines. Elwell Otis, the US Military Governor-General, order an intensive drive to the north with the aim of pursuing Emilio Aguinaldo who originally established his government in Malolos, Bulacan. On November 12, Tarlac, the last revolutionary capital, was captured by the Americans which signaled the collapse of organized Filipino resistance. And with the fall of his top officials such as Mabini, Luna, and ²⁴ del Pilar, Aguinaldo was forced to flee to the mountains to avoid capture. Eventually, with the surrender of his personal messenger Cecilio Seguismundo and with the help of the Macabebes of Pampanga, Aguinaldo was arrested by Colonel Frederick Funston in Palanan, Isabela on March 23, 1901.

Aguinaldo was brought to Manila where he released a proclamation stating his official surrender to the United States on April 19. This was released by the office of Arthur MacArthur who succeeded Otis as the Governor-General. According to proclamation, Aguinaldo had to concede after he had chosen to heed the people's call for peace. It could be remembered that several members of Aguinaldo's own government eventually sided with the Americans and began to advocate for the annexation. At the end, he claimed that his official surrender was nevertheless a service for the Philippines.

Manila, P.I., April 19, 1901

The following address to the Filipino people is published for the information of all concerned. In order to signalize such important step in the pacification of the country, one thousand prisoners of war will, upon taking the oath of allegiance, be released and sent to their homes, for which purpose the Provost Marshal General will give the necessary orders.

ARTHUR MACARTHUR

Major General, US Army and US Military Governor in the Philippines

Emilio F. Aguinaldo, "Address to the Filipino People: April 19, 1901," accessed 25 October ²³ 2020, <http://name.umd.umich.edu/adt4867.0001.001>.

TO THE FILIPINO PEOPLE:

I believe I am not in error in presuming that the unhappy fate to which my adverse fortune has led me is not a surprise to those who have been familiar with the progress of the war. The lessons taught with a full meaning and which have recently come to my knowledge suggest with irresistible force that a complete termination of hostilities and lasting peace are not only desirable, but absolutely essential to the welfare of the Philippine Islands.

The Filipinos have never been dismayed at their weakness, nor have they faltered in following the path pointed out by their fortitude and courage. The time has come, however, in which they find their advance along this path to be impeded by an irresistible force, which, while it restrains them, yet enlightens their minds and opens to them another course, presenting them the cause of peace. This cause has been joyfully embraced by the majority of my fellow-countrymen, who have already united around the glorious sovereign banner of the United States. In this banner they repose their trust, and believe that under its protection the Filipino people will attain all those promised liberties which they are beginning to enjoy.

The country has declared unmistakably in favor of peace. So be it. There has been enough blood, enough tears, and enough desolation. This wish cannot be ignored by the men still in arms if they are animated by a desire to serve our noble people, which has thus clearly manifested its will. So do I respect this will, now that it is known to me.

After mature deliberation, I resolutely proclaim to the world that I cannot refuse to heed the voice of a people longing for peace, nor the lamentations of thousands of families yearning to see their dear ones enjoying the liberty and the promised generosity of the great American Nation.

By acknowledging and accepting the sovereignty of the United States throughout the Philippine Archipelago, as I now do, and without any reservation whatsoever, I believe that I am serving thee, my beloved country. May happiness be thine!

EMILIO AGUINALDO

Benevolent Assimilation Proclamation by US Willam McKinley, December 21, 1898. Retrieved from Blount, James. *American Occupation of the Philippines, 1898-1912*. (New York & London: G.P. Putnam's Sons, 1913)

The Benevolent Assimilation Proclamation issued by President William McKinley on December 21, 1898, is among the primary sources collated by James Blount, an American volunteer and district judge, during his sojourn in the Philippine archipelago in the early years of American occupation in the Philippine Archipelago by the turn of the 20th century. The compilation of the historical documents entitled *American Occupation of the Philippines, 1898-1912* is considered to be the culmination of Blount's anti-imperialist advocacy. Aside from offering a first-hand account of the Philippine American War and the early years of US colonization in the Philippines, the book attempts to offer a balance account of the period from the perspective of prominent figures in the Philippine-American War (such as George Dewey, Wesley Merritt, Elwell Otis and Emilio Aguinaldo, to name a few), alongside Blount's own interpretation to the turn of events that had taken place. As to the chief implementer of the Benevolent Assimilation, William McKinley was the 25th President of the United States of America who ran under the banner of the Republican Party whose main policy then involved the expansion of the power and influence of United States across the globe. The proclamation constitutes the official foreign policy of the Executive Arm of the US government in accordance to their aim in espousing their "Manifest Destiny" ideology and assuming the "white man's burden" role as their ways and means to justify their imperialist motives. Blount provided the historical background that led to the issuance of the proclamation and offered a scathing take which labels the proclamation as the "Pandora box of Philippine woes".

THE BENEVOLENT ASSIMILATION PROCLAMAION

EXECUTIVE MANSION, WASHINGTON,
December 21, 1898.

The destruction of the Spanish fleet in the harbor of Manila by the United States naval squadron commanded by the United States naval squadron commanded by Rear-Admiral Dewey, followed by the reduction of the city and the surrender of the Spanish forces, practically effected the conquest of the Philippine Islands and the suspension of Spanish sovereignty therein. With the signature of the treaty of peace between the United States and Spain by their respective plenipotentiaries at Paris on the 10th instant, and as a result of the victories of American arms, the future control, disposition, and government of the Philippine Islands are ceded to the United States. In the fulfillment of the rights of sovereignty thus acquired and the responsible obligations of government thus assumed, the actual occupation and administration of the entire group of the Philippine Islands becomes immediately necessary, and he military government heretofore maintained by the United States in the city, harbor, and bay of Manila is to be extended with all possible dispatch to the whole of the ceded territory. In performing this duty to the military commander of the United States is enjoined to make known to the inhabitants of the

Philippine Islands that in succeeding to the sovereignty of Spain, in severing the former political relations, and in establishing a new political power, the authority of the United States is to be exerted for the securing of the persons and property of the people of the islands and for the confirmation of all their private rights and relations. It will be the duty of the commander of the forces of occupation to announce and proclaim in the most public manner that we come not as invaders or conquerors, but as friends, to protect the natives in their homes, in their employments, and in their personal and religious rights. All persons who, either by active aid or by honest submission, co-operate with the Government of the United States to give effect to these beneficent purposes will receive the reward of its support and protection. All others will be brought within the lawful rule we have assumed, with firmness if need be, but without severity, so far as possible. Within the absolute domain of military authority, which necessarily is and must remain supreme in the ceded territory until the legislation of the United States shall otherwise provide, the municipal laws of the territory in respect to private rights and property and the repression of crime are to be considered as continuing in force, and to be administered by the ordinary tribunals, so far as practicable. The operations of civil and municipal government are to be performed by officers as may accept the supremacy of the United States by taking the oath of allegiance, or by officers chosen, as far as practicable, from the inhabitants of the islands. While the control of all the public property and the revenues of the state passes with the cession, and while the use and management of all public means of transportation are necessarily reserved to the authority of the United States, private property, whether belonging to the individuals or corporations, is to be respected except for cause duly established. The taxes and duties heretofore payable by the inhabitants to the late government become payable to the authorities of the United States unless it be seen fit to substitute for them other reasonable rates or modes of contribution to the expenses of government, whether general or local. If private property be taken for military use, it shall be paid for when possible in cash, at a fair valuation, and when payment in cash is not practicable, receipts are to be given. All ports and places in the Philippine islands in the actual possession of the land and naval forces of the United States will be opened to the commerce of all friendly nations. All goods and wares not prohibited for military reasons by due announcement of the military authority will be admitted upon payment of such duties and other charges as shall be in force at the time of their importation. Finally, it should be the earnest wish and paramount aim of the military administration to win the confidence, respect, and affection of the inhabitants of the Philippines by assuring them in every possible way that full measure of individual rights and liberties which is the heritage of free peoples, and by proving to them that the mission of the United States is one of Benevolent Assimilation substituting the mild sway of justice and right for arbitrary rule. In the fulfillment of this high mission, supporting the temperate administration of affairs for the greatest good of the governed, there must be sedulously maintained the strong arm of authority, to repress disturbance and to overcome all obstacles to the bestowal of the blessings of good and stable government upon the people of the Philippine Islands under the free flag of the United States.

WILLIAM MCKINLEY

Cartas Sobre la Revolucion, 1897 1900 is a compilation of letters and correspondences of Mariano Ponce to various revolutionaries – Filipinos and foreigners alike, from whom the former had interacted and asked support for the First Philippine Republic during the turbulent turn of the 20th century. Born in Baliuag Bulacan on March 23, 1863, Mariano Ponce is famous for being part of the “triumvirate” of the Filipino propagandista movement, alongside with Marcelo Del Pilar and Jose Rizal. In February 12, 1889, Ponce, together with Del Pilar and Graciano Lopez Jaena established *La Solidaridad* wrote various articles using the pen names of *Nanking*, *Kalipulako* and *Tikbalang*. Upon the establishment of the Hongkong Junta led by Emilio Aguinaldo, Ponce was appointed as the official representative of the Philippine revolutionary government to Japan for him to study the policy of Imperial Japan towards her relations to other nations, and subsequently, to ask for military and financial support. In his letter to G. Apacible dated in January 2, 1899, Ponce mentioned the negotiations being initiated for the acquisition of ammunitions from Japan and some diplomatic arrangements, among the others. Ponce’s letter to Apacible in 1899, together with the other correspondences compiled, provide an outline of the conducts of the Philippine revolutionary government as far as diplomacy and international relations were concerned, thus, tracing its early relations to Asian nations, notably Japan and the reformist movement in China led by Dr. Sun Yat-sen. One could also discern from Ponce’s letters the emerging Asian solidarity in response to the Western intrusion in the region for the past centuries. *Cartas Sobre la Revolucion, 1897- 1900* is digitally housed in the *The United States and its Territories, 1870 – 1925: The Age of Imperialism* collection of the University of Michigan Library. Translation of the letters from Spanish to Filipino was undertaken by Professor Ma. Luisa Camagay and Professor Wistan dela Peña for its publication through the *Surian ng Wikang Filipino*.

115. LIHAM KAY APACIBLE

Mga negosasyon para sa mga armas. – Panibagong pagkaantala. – Ang mga kinatawang Filipino. – Palaging nagmamatyag ang mga Amerikano. – Paghahanap ng mga sundalo o opisyal sa hukbong reserbado ng Hapon.

637 Miyokoji Yama, Kitagata, Korakigun,

Yokohama, 2 Enero 1899.

Sr. Don G. APACIBLE,

Hongkong.

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MAHAL KONG KAIBIGAN: Natanggap ko na ang iyong mga liham na may petsang ika-5, 9, 22, at 23 ng nakaraang Disyembre. Binasa kong mabuti ang lahat ng ito. Natanggap ko ang unang sulat mula sa mga komisyonadong sinalubong ko sa Kobe tulad ng nabalitaan ninyo sa

pamamagitan ng aking *postcard*. Natanggap ko kasama ng huling sulat ang *letra de cambio* na may numero 176 na maipapalit sa Yokohama Specie Bank Ltd. Sa halagang 65.48 yen, bilang pagbabalik sa mga ginastos ko sa papel. Salamat dito. ayon sa inyong bilin, ilalagay ko bilang gastos ng representasyon dito ang mga kinuha ni Sr. G. Agoncillo. Padadalhan ko kayo ng listahan ng mga gastos dito sa susunod na liham. Wala akong panahon sa ngayon.

Tumuloy na sa San Francisco sina Sr. Luna, Sr. Lozada, at Sr. Marti noong ika-27 ng nakaraang buwan. Sinunod nila Heneral Riego at Sr. M. Rivera ang payo ng mga Hapones at naiwan sila rito. Nakatira sila sa bahay ninyo at ni Sr. Rivero. Bago umalis ang tatlong nabanggit, nakausap naming noong ika-23 ang isang taong may napakataas na posisyon sa kasalukuyang pamahalaan. Sinabi sa amin ng ginoong ito na hindi tatanggapin ng Hapon na masakop tayo ng ibang bansang makapangyarihan. Sinabi niyang natutuwa ang Hapon na gumaganda ang takbo ng ating Gobyerno at inaasam nito ang pagtatatag ng ating Republika. Hindi na siya makapagdagdag dito dahil isa siyang opisyal ng pamahalaan. Ngunit dahil itinataguyod niya ang kapayapaan, pinagpayuhan niya ang mga komisyonado na ituloy ang kanilang biyahe para sa propaganda sa Amerika at Europa, lalung-lalo na sa Inglatera at Alemanya. Walang dudang pakikilingan ng Amerika ang payo ng dalawang bansang ito. Tulad ng sinabi ko na sa inyo, higit na matutulugan tayo ng mga militar ngunit hindi tayo dapat magtaka na nagmula sa isang diplomatiko ang mga pangungusap na iyon. Hinggil naman sa kasalukuyang ginagawang negosasyon para sa mga armas, nagkaroon ng panibagong pagkaantala, ngayong pang hawak na namin ang 50 mil yen na ipinadala ninyo. Imposible kaming makakilos dahil walang tao rito mula noong Pasko. Bukod dito, palaging nagmamatyag ang mga Amerikano sa pagdating ng mga komisyonado. Ito ang pumipigil sa mga Hapon na bumuo ng isang mapanganib na desisyon. Sinasabing dapat nilang makuhan pagkatiwalaan muli ng mga Amerikano tulad ng dati bago sila kumilos. Lubos naming ikinalulungkot ito. upang madaliin ang takbo ng mga pangyayari, ipinaiwan namin dito si Heneral Riego. Hinihintay naming ngayon ang ika-8 sa pagbalik ng mga nagsipagbakasyon at muli naming lalakaran ang bagay na ito. kapag natapos na ang mga nakabimbing negosasyon at narito na ang hahalili sa akin, uuwi na ako dahil ito rin ang kagustuhan ng ating Presidente. Naghahanap kami ng mga sundalong retirado o nasa hukbong reserbado na gustong sumama. Dapat maganda ang kanilang ugali, marunong ng Ingles o Pranses, at hindi mahirap pakisamahan. Hindi ito pagsasantabi ng mga opisyal na maaring ibigay sa ating pamahalaan. Sinabi sa akin ng Direktor ng Giyera sa isang liham na may 50 ang kailagan doon. Mahihirapan ang pamahalaan na bigyan tayo ng ganoon karaming mga opisyal. Binabati ko kayo ng Manigong Bagong Taon at muli nagsasabing isa ninyong magili na kaibigan at kasama si

M. PONCE.